MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級プラス
リーディングトレーニング

第9回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級プラス形式のリーディング第9回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To ( ) the safety of night cyclists, the town installed solar-powered reflectors along the riverbank path.

1 enforce **2** enclose **3** endure **4** enhance

(2) Students wishing to change clubs must submit a signed form to the office ( ) to the Friday deadline.

1 contrary **2** prior **3** owing **4** immune

(3) When the microphone suddenly cut out, the speaker carried ( ) calmly by projecting her voice across the room.

1 off **2** out **3** on **4** away

(4) A thorough warm-up routine is an essential ( ) against ankle sprains in winter track events.

1 precaution **2** prediction **3** permission **4** possession

(5) Because both finalists scored identical points, the judges awarded first prize to them ( ).

1 jolly **2** jealously **3** justly **4** jointly

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(6) The historic cedar tree remained (　　) even after typhoon winds snapped several newer utility poles nearby.

1 intact　**2** intense　**3** internal　**4** informal

(7) All volunteer translators are asked to keep the contents of medical interviews strictly (　　).

1 commercial　**2** confidential　**3** conventional　**4** controversial

(8) Before signing a rental lease, read every clause carefully so you do not (　　) hidden repair fees.

1 overcome　**2** overtake　**3** overlook　**4** overflow

(9) The island ferry runs on a reduced winter timetable; (　　), the last boat back to the mainland leaves at 4:30 p.m.

1 reluctantly　**2** specifically　**3** conversely　**4** miraculously

(10) Local farmers attribute this autumn's unusually sweet pears (　　) warm daytime sunshine and cool mountain nights.

1 into　**2** for　**3** with　**4** to

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) Many smartphone users take instant map navigation for (　　) until their battery dies in an unfamiliar city.

1 granted　**2** grateful　**3** guaranteed　**4** grounded

(12) The outdoor stage was covered with a canvas canopy (　　) sudden mountain showers during the orchestra performance.

1 by virtue of　**2** in spite of　**3** in case of　**4** at the expense of

(13) Adding crushed walnut shells to winter boot soles helps (　　) grip on wet ice without scratching indoor floors.

1 breed　**2** boast　**3** blush　**4** boost

(14) Although the two pottery towns lie just ten kilometers apart, their glazes differ (　　) in color and texture.

1 mutually　**2** merely　**3** markedly　**4** mildly

(15) Had it not (　　) for the lifeguard's quick whistle, the swimmer might have drifted into the boat lane.

1 be　**2** been　**3** being　**4** was

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) By (　　) of solar-heated water pipes under the greenhouse benches, seedlings survive subzero nights without oil heaters.

1 means　**2** terms　**3** sake　**4** way

(17) The museum curator objected to (　　) flash photography near the four-hundred-year-old silk kimono.

1 be allowed　**2** allow　**3** allowed　**4** allowing

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Escalators Have Brushes Along Their Sides

Look down at the bottom edges of almost any subway or department-store escalator, and you will notice rows of stiff black nylon bristles sticking inward from both side panels. Many riders casually use them to dust off their shoes—or assume the brushes are there to sweep candy wrappers off the moving steps. In fact, engineers added skirt brushes after investigating a serious mechanical hazard.

Between each moving metal step and the stationary side wall sits a tiny gap just a few millimeters wide. Without a physical barrier, soft rubber rain boots, trailing coat drawstrings, or long shopping bags resting right against the wall can get pulled into that gap by friction as the steps descend. Once fabric or rubber wedges inside, the escalator must halt abruptly. (18), a subtle sensory warning was needed to keep feet a few centimeters toward the center.

Stiff nylon bristles solve the problem gently through human reflexes. Whenever a passenger's shoe or pant leg brushes against the bristles, the light tickling sensation prompts the person to shift inward automatically without looking down. (19), the bristles physically deflect loose shoelaces before they can reach the narrow metal clearance.

Safety authorities made side brushes mandatory on new escalators in many countries after injury rates dropped sharply in early trials. Sometimes the best engineering safeguard is not a loud alarm, but (20).

(18)

1 Conversely
2 Therefore
3 Nonetheless
4 Meanwhile

(19)

1 Otherwise
2 On the contrary
3 At the same time
4 In vain

(20)

1 a quiet tactile cue that guides behavior naturally
2 banning rubber boots from all train stations on rainy days
3 making escalator steps twice as wide as subway tunnels
4 turning off station lights so riders walk more slowly

How Ice Stupas Store Winter Water for Spring Crops

High in the cold desert valleys of Ladakh in northern India, farmers receive less than ten centimeters of rain a year. For centuries, villages depended on summer meltwater trickling down from mountain glaciers to irrigate barley, peas, and apricot trees. As smaller low-altitude glaciers have retreated, however, streams now run dry during critical planting weeks in April and May, only to surge later in July.

Building concrete reservoirs at four thousand meters is costly, and shallow ponds freeze solid or evaporate quickly in fierce high-altitude sun. In 2013, local engineer Sonam Wangchuk tested an ingenious geometric alternative: piping unused winter stream water downhill by gravity and spraying it upward into subzero night air. Freezing as it falls, the spray builds a towering cone of ice thirty meters tall, shaped like a traditional Buddhist monument or stupa. (21), a cone exposes far less surface area to spring sunshine per liter of ice than a flat pond does.

Because of that compact shape, an ice stupa melts slowly throughout April, May, and June—releasing steady trickles of water right when young barley shoots need moisture most. Local youths maintain the pipes without electric pumps, since height difference alone creates water pressure. (22), villages can store millions of liters of winter runoff using simple hardware-store pipes.

Ice stupas cannot replace glacier conservation on a global scale, yet they give mountain communities (23) while adapting to shifting snowmelt seasons.

(21)

1 By contrast
2 Reluctantly
3 Otherwise
4 Crucially

(22)

1 As a result
2 Nevertheless
3 On the contrary
4 Until then

(23)

1 a machine that creates heavy summer monsoons on demand
2 a practical, low-energy way to bridge spring water shortages
3 enough electricity to heat every house in northern India
4 a reason to stop growing barley and apricot trees

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Preparing Audio Files for the Regional Drama Contest

From: Stage Technical Desk, Civic Theater
To: High School Drama Club Sound Operators
Subject: Sound file format and backup rules for Sunday's contest

Dear sound operators,
We look forward to supporting your technical rehearsal and performance this Sunday. Every year, at least one school experiences a playback hiccup because of file settings, so please check these requirements before Friday.

Submit all music cues and sound effects on a USB flash drive formatted in FAT32 or exFAT, saved as uncompressed WAV files (48 kHz, 16-bit). Do not rely on smartphones, Bluetooth receivers, or streaming apps in the booth—theater concrete walls block cellular signals, and notification chimes or automatic system updates can interrupt a quiet dramatic scene.

Name each file starting with a three-digit cue number in performance order (for example, "001_rain_intro.wav", "002_doorbell.wav"). In addition, bring an audio CD or a second identical USB drive in a separate bag as an emergency backup.

Stage Technical Desk

Preparing Audio Files for the Regional Drama Contest — Questions

(24) Why are smartphones and streaming apps prohibited for sound playback in the booth?

1 Judges listen to plays only through vinyl records.

2 Smartphones are heavier than theater mixing consoles.

3 Concrete walls block signals, and notifications or updates could disrupt a scene.

4 USB drives cannot store rain sound effects.

(25) How should sound operators name each audio file?

1 In alphabetical order by composer's birthday.

2 Starting with a three-digit cue number in performance order.

3 Using Japanese emojis only.

4 All files must have the exact same filename.

(26) What emergency backup must each school bring?

1 A live symphony orchestra.

2 Three extra smartphones.

3 Printed sheet music for the audience.

4 An audio CD or a second identical USB drive carried in a separate bag.

How Seed Vaults Keep Crop Diversity Alive Underground

Walk through a modern supermarket, and the fruit and vegetable section looks wonderfully varied. Yet agricultural historians point out a quiet vulnerability behind that colorful display: globally, just nine plant species account for nearly two-thirds of all crop production, and farmers within each crop increasingly plant a handful of high-yielding commercial varieties. While uniform crops simplify harvesting and transport, genetic uniformity carries risk. If a new fungal disease or prolonged drought strikes a widely planted wheat or potato variety, entire regions can lose harvests simultaneously.

Over previous centuries, peasant farmers maintained thousands of local "landrace" varieties—grains and beans adapted to salty coastal soil, high mountain frost, or short desert rains. When farms switch to modern commercial seeds, those hardy older varieties can vanish within a single generation unless someone preserves viable seeds.

That is the mission of over a thousand seed banks worldwide, backed up by the Svalbard Global Seed Vault deep inside an Arctic mountain in Norway. Sealed in moisture-proof foil packets at minus eighteen degrees Celsius, orthodox seeds such as wheat, rice, and lentils slow their metabolism so dramatically that they remain capable of sprouting for decades or even centuries. Permafrost surrounding the Arctic rock tunnel provides natural refrigeration even if external power temporarily fails.

Even the coldest vault is not a "set-and-forget" museum, however. Seeds slowly lose vigor over time and must periodically be thawed, planted in soil, harvested fresh, and frozen anew. Moreover, tropical crops with moist, fleshy seeds—such as cacao, mango, and avocado—cannot survive standard freezing at all; scientists preserve their diversity in living field collections or ultra-cold liquid nitrogen.

Safeguarding ancient seeds is ultimately forward-looking work: traits hidden in an obscure mountain grain today may hold the exact drought resistance breeders need fifty years from now.

How Seed Vaults Keep Crop Diversity Alive Underground — Questions

(27) What agricultural risk of planting uniform commercial crop varieties is highlighted in the first paragraph?

1 A new disease or severe drought can wipe out harvests across whole regions at once.

2 Supermarkets run out of colorful price tags.

3 Tractors cannot harvest crops of the same height.

4 Uniform wheat refuses to grow in sunny weather.

(28) Why is the Svalbard Global Seed Vault located inside an Arctic mountain with permafrost?

1 Cargo ships can reach Svalbard in ten minutes from anywhere.

2 Wheat and rice grow outdoors on Arctic snowfields in January.

3 Permafrost provides natural freezing protection even if electric power temporarily fails.

4 Cold air turns ordinary beans into tropical mangoes.

(29) Why must stored seeds periodically be planted and harvested again?

1 Vault staff eat half the stored rice every winter.

2 Seeds forget what plant they are unless exposed to music.

3 Foil packets dissolve every twelve months.

4 Even frozen seeds gradually lose vigor over long periods and need fresh replacement.

(30) Why can't crops like cacao, mango, and avocado be stored using standard minus-18-degree seed freezing?

1 No one eats cacao or avocados anymore.

2 Their seeds are too small to see under a microscope.

3 Their moist, fleshy seeds do not survive ordinary freezing.

4 Norwegian law bans fruit seeds from entering the country.

(31) Why does the author describe preserving old local seeds as "forward-looking work"?

1 Old varieties sell for gold coins in antique shops.

2 Traits in traditional varieties may provide vital disease or drought resistance needed in the future.

3 Farmers plan to abandon all modern tools and tractors next year.

4 Seed vaults double as luxury tourist hotels.